

LEAD THE WAY
BJP president J.P. Nadda gets a rousing welcome in Jaipur, May 19

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BJP CHIEF NADDA IS MOST LIKELY TO GET AN EXTENSION, BUT THE SAME MAY NOT HAPPEN FOR STATE UNIT CHIEFS WHO HAVE FINISHED THEIR TERM

has kept a decision on this on hold. The BJP sees a faint ray of hope in this. The JD(U) chief, after all, has never been the most faithful of partners. For now, the Bihar setback has certainly added to the BJP's 2024 workload. It has to go back to the drawing board: the state sends 40 MPs to the Lok Sabha; in 2019, the BJP- JD(U) combine had swept 39 of those.

The other half of the party's bifocal lens is dedicated to inward-gazing, at least in the tactical realm. J.P. Nadda's three-year tenure as party president comes to an end in early 2023, but he is likely to get an extension to anchor preparations for 2024. That leeway doesn't extend to state unit chiefs whose terms are ending. Since July-end, the party has replaced many of them—Mandan Kaushik has given way to Mahendra Bhatt in Uttarakhand, Manik Saha to Ranjib Bhattacharjee in Tripura, Vishnu Deo Sai to Arun Sao in Chhattisgarh, Chandrakant Patil to Chandrashekhar Bhawankule in Maharashtra, Swatantra Dev Singh to Bhupinder Chaudhary in Uttar Pradesh. All of them, besides pucca RSS and/or ABVP credentials, also tick the right caste boxes in those states.

The BJP is also contemplating changes in the Karnataka, Rajasthan, Bihar and MP leadership, and not